OPEN UNIVERSITY MALAYSIA

ASSIGNMENT

MPU3243
ENVIRONMENTAL STUDIES
SEPTEMBER 2025 SEMESTER

HUTECH, VIETNAM

SPECIFIC INSTRUCTION

1. Answer in **ENGLISH.**

2. The number of words: **2500 – 3000 words excluding** references (**applicable for TASK 2**).

3. Submit your assignment **ONCE** only in **MULTIPLE** files.

4. Submit your assignment **ONLINE.**

5. Submission date:

6. This assignment accounts for **70%** of the total marks for the course.

ASSIGNMENT QUESTIONS

PURPOSE

The objective of this assignment is to analyse the sources and impacts of plastic pollution, as well as explore the relationship between climate change and global food security.

TASK 1: REVIEW ARTICLES

a) Find **TWO** research articles related to plastic pollution.

b) Based on all the research articles gathered in (a) complete the following literature review matrix:

Research Articles	Author(s)	Publication Year	Issues or Problem Statement	Research Objective(s) or Research Question(s)	Methodology	Summary of the Key Findings (30 – 50 words)
1						
2						

(10 marks)

TASK 2 – WRITTEN ESSAY

Plastic pollution has become a major environmental challenge affecting ecosystems, wildlife, and human health globally. Despite efforts to manage plastic waste, its impact on the environment continues to grow.

From the statement above, you need to write your essay addressing the following areas of concern:

a) The main sources and types of plastic pollution in oceans and rivers.
b) The effects of plastic pollution on marine and terrestrial ecosystems.
c) International and local initiatives aimed at reducing plastic waste and promoting sustainable alternatives.

[30 marks]

TASK 3 – VIDEO PRESENTATION

Climate change is increasingly influencing weather patterns and human activities across the globe, impacting agriculture, health, and infrastructure.

Based on this statement, you are required to produce a PowerPoint and video presentation to explain how climate change affects global food security.

1. Your video presentation **must** include your slides, and the presenter **must** be visible.
2. The video presentation duration is between **5 to 6 minutes** only.

3. Your PowerPoint and video presentation may be based on the following main criteria:
   a) The relationship between climate change and agricultural productivity.
   b) Solutions and adaptations to improve food security in the context of climate change.

[30 marks]

***Terms of Submission**

You need to submit **TWO** different files:

1. One type of file MS Word format doc., docx (TASK 1 and TASK2).
2. One type of file for video presentation format mp4, mpeg 4, avi, mov, mkv, flv (TASK 3)
3. **DO NOT SUBMIT** TASK 2 in PowerPoint format ppt. or pptx. as it will affect your marks.
4. For grading, please refer to the rubric evaluation.

[Total: 70 marks]

ASSIGNMENT RUBRICS

MPU3243 ENVIRONMENTAL STUDIES / SEPTEMBER 2025 / HUTECH, VIETNAM

TASK 1: REVIEW ARTICLES

*QN	CLO	Criteria	Weight	Excellent	Good	Fair	Poor	Unsatisfactory	Max Marks
				4	3	2	1	0	
1	CLO1	Literature reviews matrix is prepared.	2.5	The matrix thoroughly summarises the key elements of each research article. The language used is clear, concise, and free of ambiguities. The matrix is easy to read and understand, facilitating effective communication of the compiled information.	The matrix summarises the key elements of each research article. The language is clear, but there may be occasional instances of ambiguity or complexity that could be improved for better understanding.	The matrix summarises the key elements of each research article. The language used may be somewhat unclear or verbose, hindering the overall understanding of the compiled information.	The literature reviews matrix is incomplete.	Literature reviews matrix is not available.	10
		Total	2.5						10

*QN = Question Number

TASK 2: WRITTEN ESSAY

*QN	CLO	Criteria	Weight	Excellent	Good	Fair	Poor	Unsatisfactory	Max Marks
				4	3	2	1	0	
2	CLO2	Introduction to the main sources and types of plastic pollution in oceans and rivers.	1.25	The introduction is very clear and supported with good references, and figures/ diagrams etc.	The introduction is relatively clear and supported by relevant references.	The introduction is brief but not supported by relevant references.	The introduction is too general and not related.	No introduction is given.	5
2	CLO2	Explain effects of plastic pollution on marine and terrestrial ecosystems.	2.5	An excellent explanation of the factors and activities and supported with good references, examples, and figures/diagrams etc.	A good explanation of the factors and activities but not supported with good references and examples.	A fairly explanation of the factors and activities.	A poor explanation of the factors and activities.	No explanation.	10
2	CLO2	Explanation on international and local initiatives aimed at reducing plastic waste and promoting sustainable alternatives.	2.5	Very good explanation. Relevant and quality details give the important information with enough and supported information.	Good explanation. Supporting details and information are relevant, but one key issue or portion of the information is unsupported.	A brief explanation. Supporting details and information are relevant, but several key issues or portions of the topics are unsupported.	General explanation. Supporting details and information are typically unclear or not related to the topic.	No explanation.	10

2	**CLO2**	**Conclusion:** • **Sum up all the main points in the assignment.**	**0.75**	**Provided a concise conclusion that clearly met the details of the criteria.**	**Provided a conclusion that mostly met the details of the criteria, but it can be improved further.**	**Provided a conclusion that basically/ minimally met the details of the criteria.**	**Provided a conclusion that poorly met the details of the criteria.**	**No conclusion was given.**	**3**
2	**CLO2**	**Proper format:** • **Cover Page, Table of Contents, proper heading and sub-heading, appropriate paragraphing, writing organised, page numbering, APA type references, etc.**	**0.5**	**Details were placed in a logical order and presented effectively, all formats were available, and all were correct. The paper is interesting. More than 6 references.**	**Details were placed in logical order but less effectively, most formats were available, and most were correct. 4 to 5 references.**	**Details were not in a logical order and distracted, most formats were available but only some were correct. There are 2 to 3 references.**	**Little sense that the writing is organised, some formats were available but not correct. Only one reference.**	**No format at all.**	**2**
		Total	**7.5**						**30**

***QN = Question Number**

TASK 3: VIDEO PRESENTATION

*QN	CLO	Criteria	Weight	Excellent	Good	Fair	Poor	Unsatisfactory	Max Marks
				4	3	2	1	0	
3	CLO3	Describing content in PowerPoint slides of the information criteria (a) and (b) in the form of a video presentation.	3.0	A very interesting quality of PowerPoint slides and very clearly describes the information that covers criteria (a) and (b) in the form of a video presentation format.	Good quality PowerPoint slides and description of the information that covers criteria (a) and (b) in the form of a video presentation format.	Describes fairly the information in PowerPoint slides covers the criteria (a) and (b) in the form of a video presentation format.	Describes of the information in PowerPoint slides cover the criteria (a) and (b) but not in the form of a video presentation format (submit only PowerPoint slides).	Fails to describe the criteria in video presentations. OR Submit TASK 2 in other than video format (PowerPoint format ppt., or pptx.)	12
3	CLO3	Delivering Sentence & Confidence	1.75	The delivery is engaging, and sentence structure is consistently correct. Presenter has a professional appearance and is well prepared without depending too much on notes. Volume, pacing, and gestures contribute maximally to the presentation.	The delivery and sentence structure are generally correct. Presenter has a professional appearance and is prepared. Appropriate voice volume, tone, and pacing. Gestures supported the overall presentation.	The delivery and sentence structure are moderately correct. Presenter has a good appearance. Strong dependence on notes and hesitation. Good voice volume, tone, and pacing. Some appropriate gestures supported the presentation.	Fails to deliver correctly. Presenter has a poor appearance and is poorly prepared. Poor voice volume, tone, and pacing. Inappropriate gestures detracted from the presentation.	Fails to describe the criteria in video presentations. OR Submit TASK 2 in other than video format (PowerPoint format ppt., or pptx.)	7

3	CLO3	Eye contact & Body Language.	1.75	Good eye contact. Presentation is full of confidence. Excellent uses of body postures and movements, smooth and convincing.	The confidence level sometime gone wobbly/unstable/ shaky. Good uses of body postures and movements, discontinue a little bit.	Lack of confidence. Suitable uses of body postures and movements, shaky all the time.	No confidence. Bad uses of body postures and movements, inert and boring.	Does not meet the requirements.	7
3	CLO3	Presentation Time Limit	1.0	Presentation is within 5 to 6 minutes.	Presentation is a way more than 6 minutes.	Presentation is very much less than 5 minutes.	Presentation without informing the time setting.	Does not meet the requirements.	4
		Total	7.5						30

*QN = Question Number